2009, Russia suggested creating a supranational reserve currency issued by the international monetary institutions. China appeared to support this proposal given by the Russian Federation, as Zhou Xiaochuan, the Governor of the People's Republic of China, called for creating a 'super-sovereign reserve currency' in the same month to replace the greenback (Lye and Yang 2010). Russia and China wanted to promote loans in local currencies and establish a currency exchange system to reduce dependence on the US dollar and lower its trade risks (Ying 2010). And again, in response to the media, the Russian President Aide Yuri Ushakov on July 10, 2014, clearly stated that:

> *Russia will propose several specific issues for consideration, including establishing a BRICS energy association to ensure the energy security of its member states and conduct integrated research and analysis of global hydrocarbon markets. It is suggested that a fuel reserve and an energy policy institute for the BRICS be created within this association*. (RT 2014)

Over some time, energy played a significant role in Russia–China relations. Thus, in 2014, Russia proposed establishing a BRICS energy association, which included establishing a fuel reserve bank and an institute of energy policies. BRICS members, including China, would benefit from this idea and give a cheerful hand in supporting Russia when it needs help from West-imposed sanctions (Tass 2015). Russia will benefit hugely from this move and become an energy consumer as an energy producer. Notably, after the Covid-19, the scope has increased abundantly.

Chinese scholars like Yina and Jinghua (2015) opined that the energy cooperation between Russia and China could be a containment strategy against the US-led West. With BRICS, Russia and China can oppose Western domination and interference in internal affairs. While attending the 2014 Brazil summit, Putin (2014) cleared that Russia should prioritize its strategic and economic cooperation within the BRICS group. At the same Summit, Xi Jinping (2014) removed that China and Russia are on the same plane where financial affairs are concerned. After disbanding the G-8 Summit, Russia said it expected greater cooperation on health issues from BRICS. Later, all the countries signed up for it, including China (Niu Haibin 2015). The BRICS cooperation and its engagement with China provided essential and much-needed support for Russia due to the West's